

Workshop

Can't wait to tinker with the official Nougat features on your older Android device? We tell you how to get them.



Instrument 1...

...a single musical instrument that you can strum like a guitar, bow like a violin, tap like a piano or loop a beat. <http://digit.in/instrmt1>

Xposed app, you should see that the framework would be installed. That's it! Xposed is now installed on your Android device. If you encounter any errors, there are several blogs dedicated to solving these errors, so you'll always find a fix to your problem.

- 5) Now you'll be able to utilise your phone better than a normal one. First, you need to browse to the download section and you'll be able to see the various modules listed. Once you pick one of those modules, you'll have to reboot your device each time to enable it. The module will either appear as an app or the app will have an internal menu in the modules section.

Now that you know how to install the modules, we'll delve into the various tweaks you can perform with the Xposed modules. We take the focus on GravityBox for Android, which is one of the best modules available for Xposed right now.

GravityBox

GravityBox is a module which gives the users features which are not available in stock Android devices such as Pie controls, display DPI changes, changing the hardware etc. When downloading the module, you'll be able to see various versions based on the software your device is running. 'LL' refers to Lollipop, 'KK' for KitKat and 'JB' for Jelly-Bean. After you install the module and then restart the device, you'll see the app listed in your app drawer. When you start the app, you'll see the app checking for root access and various permissions. Although it is not recommended to use GravityBox or Xposed on devices running non-stock devices as it might interfere with the features the OEM has baked into the Android version, it will still work in devices with near stock software like HTC or Motorola's devices.



Opening up the Xposed installer app will show you the version you've installed

Now we explain what all you can customise using Xposed:

1) Lockscreen

You can change the lockscreen wallpaper to a solid colour, set a custom image, enable blur settings effects and use ring targets. You'll also be able to change the way the battery status is shown, choosing between a bar at the top, circular and as text. You can also enable various shortcuts by using the hardware buttons and even the fingerprint sensor on supported devices! Lockscreen widgets are also popular with calendar and email applications and these can be customised too with GravityBox.

2) Status bar

The status bar is another persistent display feature on Android phones which show notification icons, status indicators, and the clock. You can modify the status bar to show the battery as a bar, change the orientation of the clock, choose various icons for the status icons and add custom text. You'll also be able to perform tweaks on the quick settings, which give you toggles for various device functions such as brightness, battery, signal and device rotation. One bonus tweak is to display the network activity as a status icon on the status bar, which shows the network upload and download speed in real time. This is useful if your carrier promises good data speeds and you feel like you're not getting what you're supposed to get. Newer features include heads up notifications which weren't previously available on devices running older versions of Android.

3) Navigation bar

The navigation bar sits at the bottom of the screen and provides you buttons for the home, back and recent apps. This can be customised to perform more functions and additional buttons, such as one for screenshots can also be added. You can also control added options on these buttons such as long press, double tap and triple tap. Some devices come with hardware buttons and if you prefer it to be on screen, you can disable the hardware keys and use the on-screen buttons.



Select the latest version to install GravitBox

4) Pie controls

Pie controls are a different take on the navigation bar. Instead of the keys resting at

the bottom of the display all the time, pie controls give you a small floating icon the various edges of the screen or allow you to access the controls with a swipe from any screen edge. This is especially useful if you feel that the navigation bar takes up significant screen real estate. You can customise the pie controls to even show the time, notification count and have buttons to toggle Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Location and turn on the torch.

5) Power menu

On a typical, close to stock device, the power menu can be accessed by long pressing the power button. Pressing the power button for a long time, will lead to the device turning off. But, what if you want to reboot just the OS? You can enable additional options here to do just that. You can set shortcuts for your favourite apps and even toggle the notification modes. To do this, you can enable the Advanced Reboot Menu on GravityBox. You can also set custom actions on the various power states in the device, such as low battery, full battery and charging indicators.